Curriculum Vitae

Carter M. Smith

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Education

University of Waterloo, Waterloo, ON
M.A. in Cognitive Psychology — Expected 2027
Advisor: *Dr. Clara Colombatto*

Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo, ON
Honours B.A. in Psychology (Research Specialization), High Distinction — 2021–2025
Thesis: *The effect of visual angle on slot machine gambling in virtual reality*
Advisor: *Dr. Nichole Scheerer*

Awards and Distinctions

- NSERC Canada Graduate Research Scholarship — Master's (2026; $27,000)
- Ontario Graduate Scholarship (2026; $15,000; declined)
- UW President's Graduate Scholarship (2026; $5,000)
- UW Faculty of Arts Connect 4 Success Award (2026; $100)
- UW Faculty of Arts Graduate Student Conference Award (2026; $200)
- UW Graduate Student Research Dissemination Award (2025; $500)
- UW Graduate Research Studentship (2025; $4,000)
- WLU Don Morgenson Memorial Award (2024; $2,000)
- WLU FOSSA Research Assistant Scholarship (2024; $1,000)
- WLU In-Course Scholarship (2021: $750; 2022–2023: $1,500)
- WLU Faculty of Science Dean's Honour Roll (2021–2024)
- WLU Entrance Scholarship (2021; $2,500)

Research Appointments

Graduate Student Researcher — *Fall 2025–Present*
University of Waterloo, Waterloo, ON

Advisor: *Dr. Clara Colombatto*

- Researching the human visual system's role in social cognition using methods from psychophysics and vision science.
- Interested in social attention, gaze cueing, and rhythmic attention.

Honours Thesis Student — *Fall 2024–Spring 2025*
Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo, ON
Advisor: *Dr. Nichole Scheerer*

- Explored how modifying the visual angle of a VR slot machine changes gambling.
- 100+ in-lab hours collecting, cleaning, and analyzing physiological and behavioural data.

Directed Study Student — *Winter 2024 & Winter 2025*
Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo, ON
Advisor: *Dr. Nichole Scheerer*

- Prepared and submitted a first-author journal article with a research team (2025).
- Cleaned and analyzed a large, primary dataset (N = 2,095) (2025).
- Preliminarily investigated an original topic for my thesis; designed an experiment (2024).
- Wrote a research proposal and presented proposal to lab members (2024).

Research Assistant — *Fall 2023–Spring 2025*
Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo, ON
Advisor: *Dr. Nichole Scheerer*

- Over 80 in-lab hours in Fall 2023 conducting data collection and analysis for speech studies.
- Technical skills: EEG, R, Excel, MATLAB, Audacity, Praat, Studio One 2.
- Independently designed, created, and presented a research poster at SONA 2024.

Research Assistant — *Spring 2023–Fall 2023*
Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo, ON
Advisor: *Dr. Marc Jambon*

- Conducted literature searches, organized large databases.
- Contributed to a meta-analysis on the associations between parental warmth and prosocial outcomes in children.

Research Assistant — *Fall 2022–Spring 2023*
Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo, ON
Advisor: *Dr. Nancy Freymond*

- Conducted archival and qualitative research.
- Examined patterns related to Indigenous marginalization in the child welfare system.
- Participated in public and scholarly seminars.

Publications

Smith, C. M., Van Esch, N., & Scheerer, N. E. (2026). Anxiety and depression among Canadian undergraduates with decreased sound tolerance. *Hearing Research, 471*, 109522.

https://doi.org/10.1016/j.heares.2025.109522

Working Papers

Smith, C. M., & Scheerer, N. E. (2025, in preparation). *Slot machine size as an arousal mechanism for optimal gambling performance.*

Oral Presentations

Smith, C. M., & Colombatto, C. (2026, June). *Minds in motion: Inferring mental states from observed kinematics.* Canadian Society for Brain, Behaviour, and Cognitive Science (CSBBCS), Toronto, ON, Canada.

Poster Presentations

Smith, C. M., & Colombatto, C. (2026, April). *Minds in motion: Inferring mental states from observed kinematics.* Southern Ontario Neuroscience Association (SONA), Hamilton, ON, Canada.

Smith, C. M., & Colombatto, C. (2026, April). *Minds in motion: Inferring mental states from observed kinematics.* Psychology Discovery Conference (PDC), Waterloo, ON, Canada.

Smith, C. M., & Colombatto, C. (2026, February). *Minds in motion: Inferring mental states from observed kinematics.* Lake Ontario Visionary Establishment (LOVE), Niagara Falls, ON, Canada.

Smith, C. M., Van Esch, N., & Scheerer, N. E. (2025, May). *Decreased sound tolerance and mental health in Canadian undergraduates.* Southern Ontario Neuroscience Association (SONA), London, ON, Canada.

Smith, C. M., & Scheerer, N. E. (2025, May). *The effect of visual angle on slot machine gambling in virtual reality.* Southern Ontario Behavioural Decision Research Conference (SOBDR), Toronto, ON, Canada.

Smith, C. M., & Scheerer, N. E. (2025, March). *The effect of visual angle on slot machine gambling in virtual reality.* Faculty of Science Students' Association Undergraduate Research Conference (FURC), Waterloo, ON, Canada.

Smith, C. M., Van Esch, N., Manning, S., & Scheerer, N. E. (2025, March). *Decreased sound tolerance and mental health in Canadian undergraduates.* FURC, Waterloo, ON, Canada.

Smith, C. M., Van Esch, N., Manning, S., & Scheerer, N. E. (2024, May). *The relationship between depression, anxiety, and symptoms of misophonia in the general population.* SONA, Waterloo, ON, Canada.

Bishai, R., Wickie, A., **Smith, C. M.**, Jones, J. A., & Scheerer, N. E. (2024, May). *Vocal motor control during exposure to variable auditory feedback.* SONA, Waterloo, ON, Canada.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant — *Winter 2026*
University of Waterloo, Waterloo, ON

- Natural Science Advanced Research Methods: Computational Methods & Tools for Research (PSYCH 390).
- Provided feedback and in-class technological troubleshooting.
- Supported students in learning new computational tools.

Teaching Assistant — *Fall 2025*
University of Waterloo, Waterloo, ON

- Introductory Psychology (PSYCH 101)
- Graded nearly 160 written assignments.
- Created novel multiple-choice questions for future tests.
- Supported student learning through clear and constructive feedback.

Instructional Assistant — *Fall 2024*
Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo, ON

- Introduction to Psychology I (PS101).
- Graded first-year assignments and provided feedback on foundational concepts.

Service and Outreach

Autism Speaks Volunteer — *Summer 2024*

- Volunteered at the 2024 Autism Speaks Walk in Waterloo Park.
- Assisted with recruitment for sensory processing research.

Community-Service Learning Student — *Winter 2023*
Wilfrid Laurier University

- Volunteered weekly at a local high school.
- Assisted students in math, English, and science.

Accessible Notetaker — *Fall 2022–Fall 2023*
Wilfrid Laurier University

- Produced and uploaded detailed lecture notes for students with documented disabilities.

Technical Skills

Statistical Software: R, JASP, jamovi, SPSS, G*Power

Programming / Tools: Python (PsychoPy), JavaScript (jsPsych), C#, Unity, HTML, R Markdown, GitHub Pages

Physiological Tools: EmotiBit, EEG, Meta Quest 2 (VR)

Advanced Data Analysis / Statistics:

- Principal components, cluster, factor, and trend analyses.
- One-way, factorial, fixed-, random- and mixed-effects ANOVAs.
- Linear and logistic regression; moderation analyses, generalized linear modeling.

Student Supervision

Undergraduate Honours Thesis Students

- Andy Bang (*2026 - Present*)

Ad-Hoc Reviewing: Journals

- *Communications Psychology*